Vertical AI Track: DAY-1 Builders Pitch Fest Problem Brief

YOUR GOAL

By the end of the buildathon (5.30pm)

1. Frame the problem
2. Design a solution that is relevant, solves the problem and that you can build in the allocated time.
3. Build and demonstrate a **working prototype** that shows how your solution solves the problem.

If any of the above are missing, points will be deducted.

PROBLEM CONTEXT

Some AI opportunities are highly specialized and do not fit neatly into broad enterprise categories such as HR, Sales, Education, or Operations. These may be focused on a specific industry, language, user group, data type, model architecture, or technical capability.

Examples may include vertical AI for healthcare, legal, manufacturing, logistics, agriculture, jewelry, energy, or other industries, as well as specialized AI areas such as multilingual AI, Indic-language AI, small language models, domain-specific models, voice AI, vision AI, edge AI, or other emerging AI capabilities.

- How can AI solve a specific problem unique to an industry, profession, language, or user group?
- How can an existing AI model be adapted with specialized knowledge or data to perform a particular task better?
- How can voice, vision, or multilingual AI make an existing task easier or accessible to a new group of users?
- How can smaller, local, or specialized AI models be used where cost, speed, privacy, or connectivity matters?
- How can AI understand and act on specialized information such as documents, images, speech, or sensor data?
- How can an emerging AI capability be turned into a useful solution for one clearly defined real-world problem?

The Challenge

Build an AI-enabled solution that solves a **specific problem for a particular industry, profession, language, user group, or technical context** or a use case above.

You are free to decide which vertical problem is most important to solve with AI among the areas above. Your solution does not need to address every issue.

Pick one meaningful problem, frame it clearly, identify where AI can genuinely make a difference, and build the strongest working prototype you can within the available time.

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Rules (Pay Close Attention)

- Maximum team size: 2 participants per startup.
- Teams may define reasonable assumptions about the problem where information is missing, but those assumptions must be stated clearly during your final presentation.
- Teams may narrow the problem to a specific user journey or use case if they believe that creates a stronger solution.
- No external human assistance during the challenge. No calls, messages, remote engineers, advisors, or outside team members.
- Internet access and AI tools such as ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Cursor, Copilot, etc. are allowed.
- Public code, framework, repository, model, API, or dataset may be used. Teams are responsible for ensuring they have the right to use any external code, data, APIs, or content they incorporate.
- Do not use real confidential, personal, or sensitive student data; use provided or synthetic data where appropriate.
- You may not use private or proprietary code that was developed by your team before the challenge. However, if that code authored by your team is already Publicly available code it may be used if disclosed
- The prototype must be substantially built during the challenge window.
- The final solution must include a working demo and one slide. The demo and slide will be presented to the judge at 5.30pm and the demo code will be uploaded to the provided link.
- Do not use confidential customer, prospect, pricing, contract, or personally identifiable information. Use publicly available, provided, or synthetic data where appropriate.
- Your prototype must demonstrate a genuinely dynamic, AI-driven solution. Limited hardcoding is acceptable for setup, workflow, or supporting functions, but hardcoded responses or logic must not be used to artificially improve the apparent quality of the AI output or to simulate intelligence that the system does not actually possess.
- Changes made after the submission deadline will not be considered for judging.

What We Want to See at 5.30pm.

You have 10mins (7mins to demonstrate and 3mins for q&a).

1. What problem you chose to solve and why - 1 SLIDE
2. Demonstrate Your working prototype
    1. How it solves the problem
    2. How AI is being used
    3. Key technical choices you made
3. What you would build next with more time